A PRACTICAL GUIDE FOR GCC BUSINESSES

AI in marketing, without the hype.

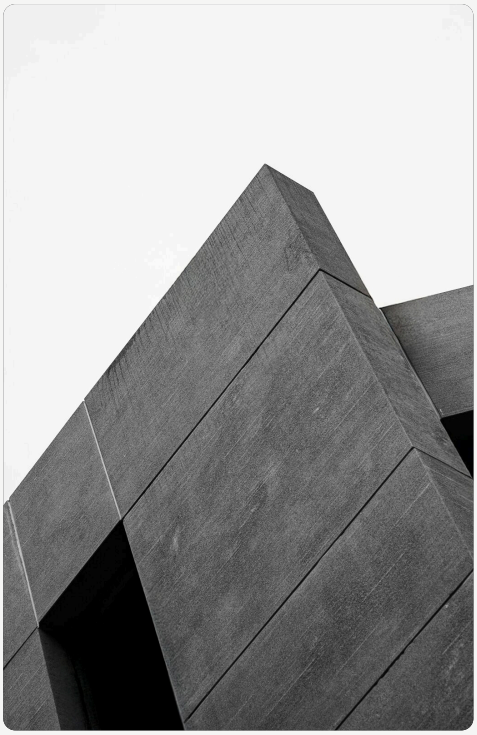
Where AI genuinely helps today, what to automate first, what to keep human, and a 30-day plan you can start on Monday.



By Wasim Ullah, Founder, SanityAI
13 years of marketing across the US, LATAM, Pakistan and the GCC

BEFORE YOU START

Most businesses don't need more **tools.** They need fewer leaks.



Every month, money is spent bringing people to a website, and a large share of those people leave without a reply, a follow-up or a reason to come back.

AI is useful in marketing when it closes those leaks: answering faster, writing first drafts faster, spotting what works sooner and showing up where buyers now ask their questions. It is far less useful when it is bolted on as a shiny feature nobody owns.

This guide is written for owners and marketing leads in the Gulf who want practical steps, not predictions. Each section ends with something you can do this week.

WHAT IS INSIDE

01	Speed to lead: reply in seconds, not hours	3
02	Being found in AI answers, not only on Google	4
03	Content with AI, edited by humans	5
04	Paid ads: feed the machine better signals	6
05	Measurement before automation	7
06	What not to hand over to AI	8
07	Your 30-day starter plan	9



01

SPEED TO LEAD

Speed to lead: reply in seconds.

The cheapest lead you will ever get is the one you already paid for. When someone fills a form or sends a WhatsApp message at 9:47 pm, the business that answers first usually gets the conversation. In most companies that reply waits until the next morning.

AI and simple automation fix this without replacing your team. An instant first reply confirms you received the message, asks one or two qualifying questions and offers a time to talk. Your team then picks up a warm conversation instead of a cold form.

AUTOMATE

The first reply, qualifying questions, booking links, reminders and a follow-up on day two and day five if there is no answer.

KEEP HUMAN

Pricing conversations, complaints, anything sensitive, and the moment a lead is ready to buy.

THIS WEEK

Send a test enquiry to your own business from your website, your ads and WhatsApp. Time how long each reply takes.



02

AI ANSWERS

Be the name AI recommends.

More buyers now ask AI assistants such as ChatGPT, Gemini and Perplexity questions like "best interior studio in Dubai Hills" or "which clinic does same-week appointments". These tools build their answers from what they can find and trust across the web.

The basics that help: a fast website with clear pages for each service and location, plain answers to the questions buyers actually ask, consistent business details everywhere (including your Google Business Profile), genuine reviews, and mentions on sites your industry respects. Structured data on your pages makes the facts easier to read.

Clear pages	One page per service and location, written in the words buyers use.
Consistent details	Same name, address, phone and hours on every profile and directory.
Proof others trust	Genuine reviews and mentions on sites your industry respects.

THIS WEEK

Ask three AI assistants who they recommend in your category and city. Note who appears and which sources they cite.



03

CONTENT

Content with AI, edited by humans.

AI is excellent at first drafts, variations and repurposing: turning one client story into a post, an email and three ad headlines. It is poor at knowing what makes your business different, and buyers notice generic copy quickly.

A simple rule works well. People decide the message and the proof. AI produces options. People edit, cut and approve. Keep a short brand sheet with your tone, words you never use, your real numbers and your best client stories, and give it to the tool every time.

GOOD USES

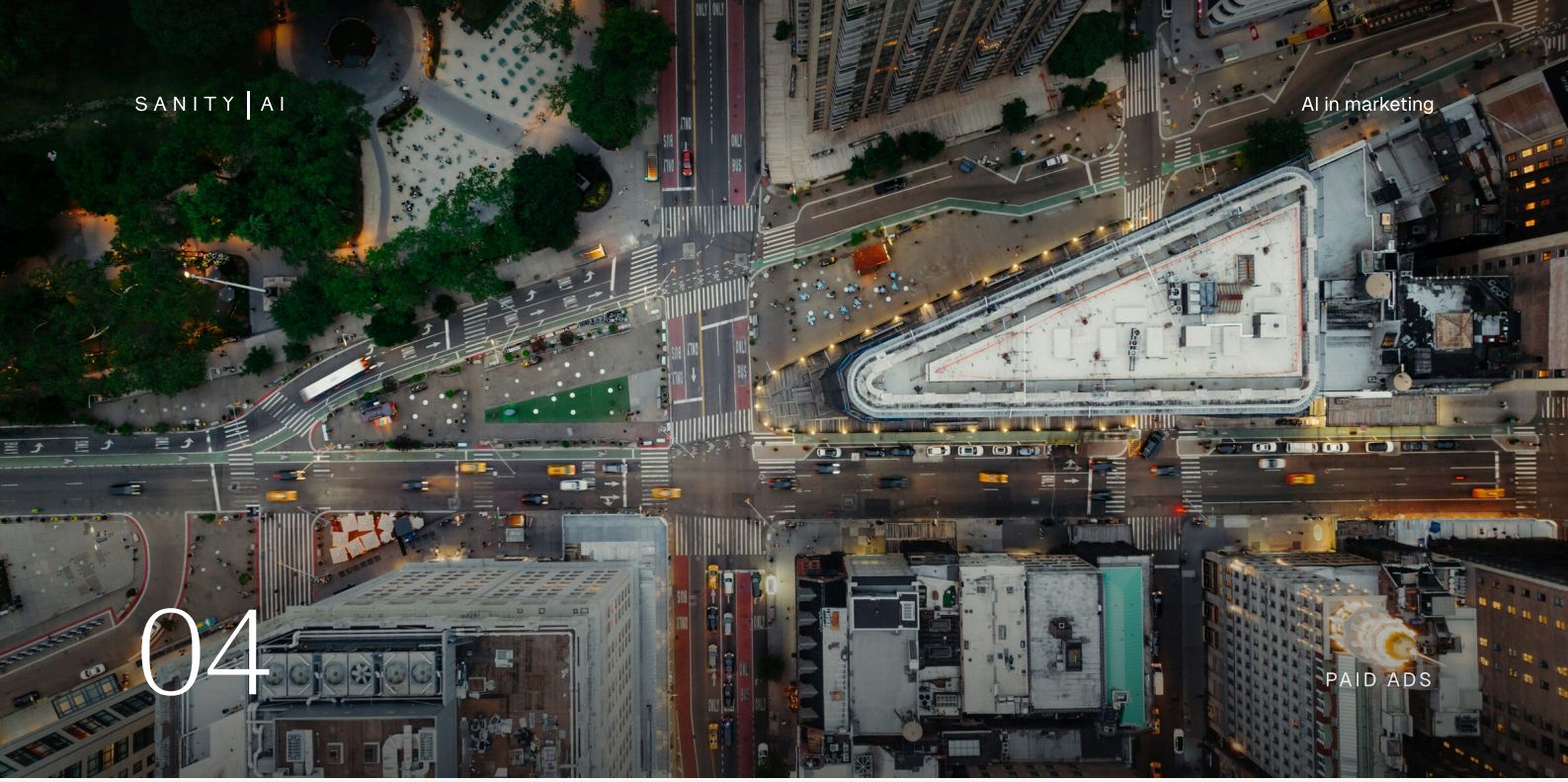
Headline and ad variations, translating and adapting Arabic and English drafts for review, summarising calls, turning long content into short formats.

WATCH OUT FOR

Invented facts and statistics, claims you cannot prove, sameness with competitors, and anything published without a human read.

THIS WEEK

Write a one-page brand sheet: your tone, ten words you never use, your real numbers and three client stories.



04

PAID ADS

Paid ads: better signals in.

Google and Meta already run much of the bidding and targeting with machine learning, through campaign types such as Performance Max and Advantage+. The machine optimises towards whatever you tell it success looks like. If that is a form fill from a bot or a click, it will find you more of those.

The biggest gains usually come from feeding the platforms better signals: tracking real enquiries and sales, sending back which leads became clients, and giving the system a range of strong creative to test. Then the automation works for you instead of against you.

Real conversions	Count enquiries and sales, not clicks or page views.
Offline results	Send back which leads became paying clients.
Creative range	Give the system several strong options to test, refreshed every few weeks.

THIS WEEK

Check what each campaign counts as a conversion. If it is not a real enquiry or sale, fix that before changing anything else.



05

MEASUREMENT

Measure first, automate second.

Automation multiplies whatever is already there. If you cannot see which channel brought which client, AI will help you spend faster in the dark. Before any new tool, make sure you can answer three questions every month.

Where from?	Which channel, campaign and page produced each enquiry.
What happened?	Which enquiries were answered, qualified, booked and won.
Worth it?	Cost per enquiry, cost per client and revenue per channel.

That usually means analytics set up properly, call and WhatsApp tracking, a simple CRM, and one monthly report in plain language. It is not glamorous, and it is the foundation everything else stands on.

THIS WEEK

Pick your last ten clients and write down where each one first came from. Gaps in that list show what to track next.



06

KEEP HUMAN

What not to hand over.

Some things should stay with people, because trust is the product. AI can prepare the ground for each of these, and a person should make the call.

Promises	Prices, discounts, timelines and guarantees.
Judgement	Positioning, brand decisions and which clients to pursue.
Sensitive cases	Health, legal and financial details, complaints and refunds.
Data	Personal data handled without consent or outside approved tools.

THIS WEEK

List every automated message you send today. Mark any that make a promise, and route those to a person.



07

30-DAY PLAN

Your 30-day starter plan.

Four weeks, one focus each. Tick them off as you go.

WEEK 1 · SEE CLEARLY

- [ ] Test reply times on every channel
- [ ] List what each campaign counts as a conversion
- [ ] Check your Google Business Profile details
- [ ] Ask AI assistants who they recommend

WEEK 2 · STOP THE LEAKS

- [ ] Set an instant reply on forms and WhatsApp
- [ ] Add two qualifying questions
- [ ] Add a booking link to every reply
- [ ] Set day-two and day-five follow-ups

WEEK 3 · FEED THE SIGNALS

- [ ] Track real enquiries and sales
- [ ] Send won clients back to ad platforms
- [ ] Write five new ad variations, edit them by hand
- [ ] Pause what has not produced enquiries

WEEK 4 · BE FINDABLE

- [ ] One clear page per service and location
- [ ] Answer the ten questions buyers ask most
- [ ] Ask recent clients for honest reviews
- [ ] Agree one monthly report everyone reads

The aim is not more activity. It is one clear view of where clients come from, and faster replies when they arrive.



SANITY | AI

Want a second pair of eyes on *your marketing?*

SanityAI is a Dubai marketing team for websites, ads, search and WhatsApp automation, measured on enquiries and revenue. Book a free 20-minute call and we will look at your site, ads and enquiries with you and name the first three fixes.

$1M+
Revenue traced to campaigns we have run

60%
Lower cost per acquisition across four GCC markets

13
Years of marketing across the US, LATAM, Pakistan and the GCC

WhatsApp +971 58 578 5819

work@sanity.ai

SanityAI is a business of Safia Saif LLC, Wasl Village, Dubai, United Arab Emirates